

TEACHING

Anyone, anywhere, can learn to restore living soil.



A mentor teaching on working land.

From curiosity through to professional practice. Everyone starts with the Foundation Courses, and where you go next depends on whether you want to apply your skills to your own land or help others improve their soils.

Foundation Courses

You'll learn the science of the soil food web, the organisms and their roles, use of a microscope for biological analyses and how biological amendments are made and applied. They are online, self-paced, take about 150 hours to complete, and are a prerequisite to any Advanced Program.

Advanced Programs

Learn the practical application of the theory you learned in the Foundation Courses through mentor-led Advanced Programs on Soil Microscopy, BioComplete™ Compost Production, Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial.

Accelerator Workshops

The Advanced Programs as a group on working land, the whole method at once. Held periodically with a host partner. Dates on the school site.

Where it leads

All four Advanced Programs carry the Soil Food Web Consultant title; Soil Microscopy alone, the Lab Technician title. Prices at school.soilfoodweb.com



Apply for a scholarship

Scholarships prioritize applicants in under-resourced regions.

sfw.one/brochure-scholarship

COMMUNITY

A global community amplifies the impact of this vital work.



A workshop group around a finished compost pile.



Join the free online community

Meet other people in the regenerative agricultural space. Get your questions answered by other practitioners of the soil food web approach who share the desire to restore the world's soils.

sfw.one/brochure-community

Dr. Elaine's soil food web approach is the key to rapid and effective soil regeneration. Only with the complete soil food web in place can the ecological functions of the soil be restored, protecting and purifying the world's waterways, reversing climate change and providing more nutritious foods. It's easy to find your place in this movement. Reach out to discover opportunities to join us as a student, volunteer, ambassador, donor and partner. info@soilfoodweb.com



STUDY



VOLUNTEER



DONATE



HOST

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Soil Food Web Foundation is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization, EIN 39-4439236. The Soil Food Web School is a program of the Foundation.



Donate

Gifts fund open research, scholarships and field projects. Tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law.

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Soil Food Web
Foundation

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit



The soil beneath our farms and forests is alive.

A web of bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods feeds plants, builds soil, stores carbon and cleans water *when it is intact*.

For forty-five years, Dr. Elaine Ingham mapped the Soil Food Web and taught the world to restore it. We carry her legacy forward: showing **what** is possible, teaching **how** to partner with life in the soil, researching **why** things work or do not, and getting dirty through **direct action** on working land. Living soil is the solution, and it is beneath your feet.



EDUCATION



RESEARCH



PRACTICE



COMMUNITY

132+

Countries in our student and practitioner community

10,000+

Individuals enrolled in our programs

45

Years of pioneering soil biology research behind the method

Healing soil.
Feeding humanity.
Restoring the living world.

OUR STORY

It began with one scientist looking closer.



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

The Soil Food Web Foundation was established in October 2025 to carry forward the life's work of Dr. Elaine Ingham, the pioneering scientist whose research transformed our understanding of soil biology and its central role in food production, ecosystem health, and planetary regeneration.

She passed away in February 2026, and the work she started continues through the Foundation, the school that is a part of it, and Soil Food Web practitioners in more than 132 countries, who are helping to restore the world's soils.



Examine Dr. Ingham's publications here: sfw.one/publications

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CLIMATE

Soil carbon sequestration is widely recognized as a part of the solution to climate change impacts. Plants pull carbon from the air and invest much of it in the soil, where it is built into microbial bodies, aggregates and complex fungal networks. A biological approach to soil management reduces equipment emissions, reduces fertilizer and irrigation needs and creates more nutritious crops. Regenerating the world's soils using the Soil Food Web Approach can improve atmospheric carbon levels. Be part of the soil-ution!



Join our free online community

Learn from and connect with other passionate people in the regenerative agriculture space. You can also register for our newsletter and webinar series via the link in this QR code.

sfw.one/brochure-webinar

RESEARCH

The science is open, and anyone can test it.



Soil samples beside the microscope.

What biologically complete, properly-structured soil does



NUTRIENT CYCLING



CREATES SOIL STRUCTURE



INHIBITS WEED PRESSURE



REDUCES PESTS AND DISEASE



Testate amoeba, 40x objective. Photograph: Joy Kaluf. A microbial count names what is present in the sample and their relative numbers: bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods.

What we test before we recommend remediation plans



Diagnostic first. Every recommendation starts with a biological analysis under a microscope.



Measurable. We provide a relative count of various microbes present in your soil or compost sample.



Adaptation and retrofitting. We help you convert your current operations to the soil food web approach, at any scale.

We train people who help farmers to transition away from using chemicals, to using biology. This results in significant benefits to the farmer and to the environment, as well as to the consumer. The method has been proven effective on 6 continents and across all soil types, as evidenced by our ever-increasing case study library.

PRACTICE

Growers are already implementing the soil food web approach, at every scale.



Agroecology plots at Rancho Cacachilas.

The basic methodology is universal; the application is based upon locally-sourced materials. Our case studies and field trials demonstrate the efficacy across a range of soil types at every scale from market gardens to massive industrial farming operations.

Nick Padwick farms four thousand acres in Norfolk, England. Roberto Silva works a hundred and forty in Piura, Peru. Jenn Sirp grows on a quarter acre in California. Check out their individual accounts of how the soil food web approach changed their operations through reducing inputs, creating better outputs and improving their bottom lines.

Though the projects run from backyard gardens to expansive public parks, the same process is applicable. The steps are the same at every scale: look at the biology under a microscope, add what is missing to rebalance the microbial content, then measure again to confirm microbial counts are going in the expected directions.

We partner with growers to teach them microscopy and biological compost creation and application so they can implement the approach where they farm, and document the impacts.



Watch the case studies

Growers filming their own soil, crop by crop and climate by climate. Start with one that looks like yours.

sfw.one/brochure-casestudies